

PAKISTAN-INDIA RELATIONS

& THE KASHMIR CONFLICT

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Part 1: Genesis and Timeline of Pakistan-India Relations (1947-June 2026)

The relationship between Pakistan and India has been shaped by deep-rooted historical, territorial, and ideological differences since the partition of British India in 1947. The Kashmir issue remains the core dispute and a flashpoint for military escalations between the two nuclear-armed nations. Over seven decades, the rivalry has evolved from conventional warfare to nuclear deterrence, proxy conflicts, and now cyber-hybrid warfare.

Phase I: Partition and Early Wars (1947-1971)

1.1 First Kashmir War (1947-48)

After partition, the princely state of Jammu & Kashmir — a Muslim-majority area ruled by Hindu Maharaja Hari Singh — became contested. In October 1947, tribal fighters from Pakistan's North-West Frontier invaded Kashmir. The Maharaja signed the Instrument of Accession to India on October 26, 1947, allowing Indian troops to enter.

- The war continued until January 1949 when the UN mediated a ceasefire through UNCIP
- The ceasefire line divided Kashmir: India controlled Jammu, Kashmir Valley, Ladakh; Pakistan controlled Azad Jammu & Kashmir (AJK) and Gilgit-Baltistan
- UN Resolution 47 (1948) called for a plebiscite which remains unimplemented to this day
- The ceasefire line became known as the Line of Control (LoC) after the 1972 Simla Agreement

"Kashmir is the jugular vein of Pakistan." — Muhammad Ali Jinnah, Founder of Pakistan

1.2 Indus Waters Treaty (1960)

Signed on September 19, 1960, between PM Nehru and President Ayub Khan, with World Bank mediation. Considered one of the most successful water-sharing agreements globally.

Indus Waters Treaty: River Allocation	
Eastern Rivers (India)	Ravi, Beas, Sutlej — full rights to India
Western Rivers (Pakistan)	Indus, Jhelum, Chenab — allocated to Pakistan; limited Indian use for non-consumptive purposes
Pakistan's Dependence	~80% of agriculture depends on Indus irrigation; 16 million hectares irrigated
World Bank Role	Permanent Indus Commission oversees implementation

"Blood and water cannot flow together." — PM Narendra Modi, September 2016 (post-Uri attack)

In 2025, following the Pahalgam attack, India suspended the IWT — the first time the treaty has been abrogated in 65 years, creating existential water security fears in Pakistan.

1.3 Second Indo-Pak War (1965)

- Pakistan launched Operation Gibraltar in August 1965 to incite rebellion in Indian-administered Kashmir
- India crossed the international border advancing towards Lahore and Sialkot — full-scale war for 17 days
- Tashkent Agreement (January 10, 1966) brokered by USSR: both withdrew to pre-war positions
- Lal Bahadur Shastri died mysteriously in Tashkent a day after signing; Pakistan viewed outcome as diplomatic failure

1.4 Third Indo-Pak War & Bangladesh Liberation (1971)

1971 War: Key Outcomes	
Trigger	Awami League won 1970 elections but was denied power; Operation Searchlight crackdown
Refugee Crisis	10 million+ Bengali refugees fled to India
Surrender	December 16, 1971 — Lt. Gen. Niazi surrendered to Lt. Gen. Jagjit Singh Aurora in Dhaka
POWs	90,000+ Pakistani soldiers captured — largest since WWII
Result	Creation of Bangladesh; severe blow to Pakistan's military and psychology
Political Impact	Fall of General Yahya Khan; rise of Zulfikar Ali Bhutto

1.5 Simla Agreement (1972)

- Signed July 2, 1972 by Indira Gandhi and Z.A. Bhutto
- Recognized LoC as de facto border; committed to bilateral resolution excluding third parties
- India interprets this as barring UN/OIC intervention; Pakistan argues it weakened international Kashmir support

"We believe in peaceful coexistence. But peaceful coexistence presupposes mutual respect and equality." — Z.A. Bhutto at Simla, 1972

Phase II: Nuclearization Era (1974-1998)

1.6 Indian Nuclear Test — Pokhran-I (1974)

On May 18, 1974, India conducted its first underground nuclear test ('Smiling Buddha') at Pokhran, Rajasthan. Described as a 'peaceful nuclear explosion' but it triggered South Asia's nuclear arms race.

- India conducted the test under PM Indira Gandhi; shocked Pakistan
- Bhutto accelerated Pakistan's nuclear program, recruiting Dr. A.Q. Khan in 1975
- Dr. Khan brought centrifuge enrichment technology from the Netherlands (URENCO)

"Even if we have to eat grass, we will make the bomb." — Zulfikar Ali Bhutto, 1974

1.7 Siachen Conflict (1984-Present)

Siachen Glacier: World's Highest Battlefield	
Altitude	Over 20,000 feet (6,000m) — world's highest battlefield
Indian Operation	Operation Meghdoot (April 1984) — preemptive occupation
Annual Cost	India: ~\$300 million; Pakistan: ~\$100 million
Casualties	Thousands — mostly from avalanches, frostbite, extreme weather
Ceasefire	2003 ceasefire holding but no demilitarization
Glacier Retreat	Climate change causing rapid melting; environmental catastrophe

1.8 Kashmir Insurgency (1989-Present)

The insurgency formally began in 1989 following allegations of rigged 1987 elections. Disillusioned Kashmiri youth turned to armed rebellion. Pakistan was accused of providing arms, training, and safe havens to groups like Hizbul Mujahideen and Lashkar-e-Taiba.

Kashmir Insurgency: Human Cost (1989-June 2026)	
Estimated Deaths	70,000+ (official); 90,000+ (human rights groups)
Indian Troops Deployed	700,000-800,000 — highest troop-to-civilian ratio globally
Disappeared Persons	8,000+ documented by APDP
Mass Graves	2,700+ unmarked graves discovered (2009)
Kashmiri Pandit Exodus	350,000-400,000 fled in early 1990s
AFSPA	Armed Forces Special Powers Act grants immunity to soldiers
PSA	Public Safety Act allows detention without trial for up to 2 years

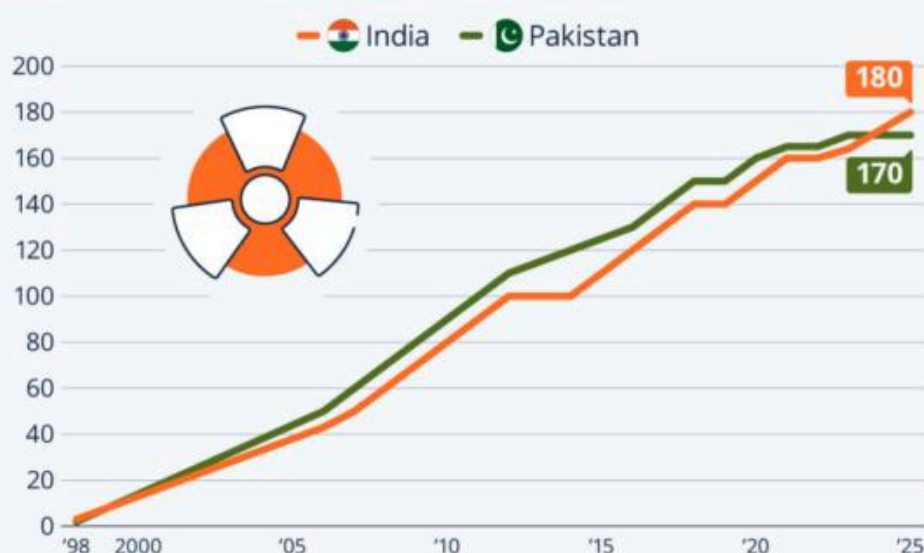
1.9 Pakistan Nuclear Tests — Chagai-I & II (1998)

After India's Pokhran-II tests (May 11-13, 1998), Pakistan conducted six nuclear tests on May 28-30, 1998, at Chagai Hills, Balochistan. This formalized nuclear deterrence in South Asia.

Nuclear Arsenal: India vs Pakistan (SIPRI 2025/2026)	
India's Warheads (2025)	~180 warheads (SIPRI Yearbook 2025)
Pakistan's Warheads (2025)	~170 warheads
India's Policy	No First Use (NFU) — declared but questioned
Pakistan's Policy	First use doctrine; Full Spectrum Deterrence
India's 2025 Spending	\$92.1 billion — world's 5th largest (SIPRI)
Pakistan's 2025 Spending	\$11.9 billion — 11% increase
India's 2026 Budget Hike	+15.2% planned
Pakistan's 2026 Budget Hike	+13.5% planned

India and Pakistan's Nuclear Warhead Buildup

Estimated nuclear warhead stockpiles by country



As of Jun. 12, 2025

Source: Federation of American Scientists



statista

Figure 1: India-Pakistan Nuclear Warhead Buildup. Source: Federation of American Scientists

Phase III: Limited Wars and Terrorism (1999-2008)

1.10 Kargil War (1999)

- Pakistani troops infiltrated Kargil heights under General Musharraf, allegedly without PM Sharif's approval
- Indian casualties: ~527 soldiers; Pakistani: 400-700+ estimates
- President Bill Clinton pressured Nawaz Sharif to withdraw (July 4, 1999 Washington meeting)
- Led to October 1999 military coup; Musharraf ousted Sharif
- Nullified Lahore Declaration (Feb 1999) — the closest both nations came to peace

1.11 Indian Parliament Attack (2001)

On December 13, 2001, five militants stormed Parliament killing 14. India blamed JeM and LeT. Operation Parakram mobilized 500,000+ troops for 10 months — largest deployment since WWII.

- U.S., Russia, EU intervened diplomatically fearing nuclear war
- Musharraf pledged crackdown on militant groups (January 2002 speech)

1.12 Mumbai 26/11 Attacks (2008)

Mumbai 26/11: Attack Details	
Date	November 26-29, 2008
Perpetrators	10 Lashkar-e-Taiba militants infiltrated via sea
Targets	Taj Palace, Oberoi Trident, Leopold Cafe, CSMT, Nariman House
Deaths	166 killed including 26 foreign nationals from US, UK, Israel, Germany
Injured	300+ injured
Captured Attacker	Ajmal Kasab — executed November 2012
Global Impact	UN designated JuD as terrorist org; deepened Indo-US counterterror cooperation; FATF tightened scrutiny on Pakistan

Phase IV: Dialogue, CBMs, and Renewed Tensions (2004-2016)

1.13 Musharraf's Four-Point Formula (2006)

- Demilitarization of Kashmir region by both sides
- Self-governance/autonomy without secession

- Joint supervision mechanism (India, Pakistan, Kashmiris)
- No border redrawing — softening of LoC for free movement and trade

Backchannel talks progressed until Mumbai 2008 attacks froze all negotiations. Cross-LoC bus service and trade initiated during this period.

1.14 Burhan Wani Killing (2016)

Burhan Wani Aftermath (July 2016)	
Profile	22-year-old Hizbul Mujahideen commander; social media icon
Funeral	200,000+ attendees defying curfews
Deaths	90+ killed in clashes
Pellet Injuries	6,221 injured including 782 eye injuries
Blindings	1,178 persons with eye damage (hospital records Jul-Oct 2016)
Longest Curfew	53 consecutive days in some areas

Wani's killing marked a turning point — the rise of 'homegrown militancy' and youth radicalization via social media.

1.15 Uri Attack & Surgical Strikes (2016)

- September 18, 2016: Militants attacked Uri army base killing 19 soldiers
- September 29, 2016: India claimed 'surgical strikes' across LoC — first publicly acknowledged cross-border raid
- India boycotted SAARC summit in Islamabad; summit cancelled
- Pakistan denied surgical strikes occurred; called it media fabrication

Phase V: Article 370 Revocation and Post-2019 Escalation

1.16 Pulwama-Balakot Crisis (February 2019)

Pulwama-Balakot Crisis Timeline	
Feb 14, 2019	Suicide bomber killed 40 CRPF personnel in Pulwama, Kashmir
Feb 26, 2019	Indian airstrikes in Balakot, KPK — claimed hitting JeM camp
Feb 27, 2019	Pakistan retaliated with Operation Swift Retort; shot down MiG-21
Captured Pilot	Wing Commander Abhinandan Varthaman — released within 48 hours
Escalation Risk	Closest to full-scale war between nuclear powers since 1971

1.17 Revocation of Article 370 (August 5, 2019)

India revoked Article 370 and 35A, stripping J&K's special status. The state was bifurcated into two Union Territories: Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh.

Article 370 Revocation: Impact	
Internet Shutdown	213 days — one of world's longest
Mass Arrests	Mehbooba Mufti, Omar Abdullah, 500+ politicians detained
Troop Surge	40,000 additional troops deployed
Demographic Fear	Non-residents can now buy land; Kashmiri Muslims fear engineered change
DDC Elections	December 2020 — first polls post-revocation; Gupkar Alliance won majority
Delimitation 2022	Redrawing constituencies favoring Jammu region

"Kashmir has been wrongly looked upon as a prize for India or Pakistan. It has an individual existence and its people must be the final arbiters of their future." — Jawaharlal Nehru, 1951



Figure 2: Kashmir Territorial Control — Pakistan-occupied Kashmir, Aksai Chin (China), and LoC

Phase VI: Latest Developments (2020-June 2026) — CRITICAL UPDATE

1.18 Galwan Valley Clash & Ladakh Standoff (2020)

India-China Galwan Clash (June 2020)

India-China Galwan Clash (June 2020)	
Date	June 15, 2020
Location	Galwan Valley, eastern Ladakh
Indian Casualties	20 soldiers killed in brutal hand-to-hand combat
Chinese Casualties	Officially undisclosed; estimates 35-45+
Impact on Kashmir	India diverted 10,000+ troops from Kashmir to Ladakh
Strategic Shift	India faced two-front threat; re-evaluated military posture

- Standoff continued through 2021; multiple disengagement agreements reached
- China built permanent infrastructure in disputed areas; India beefed up Ladakh deployment
- Impact: India's focus partially shifted from Pakistan to China; Pakistan viewed this as strategic opportunity

1.19 Backchannel Talks & Thaw (2020-2021)

In December 2020, India approached Pakistan offering backchannel talks on all outstanding issues including Kashmir. This represented a major policy shift.

- Talks held between intelligence leaderships (ISI and RAW) — preferred by India over political platform
- Pakistan's primary demand: restoration of J&K statehood and no demographic changes
- February 2021: India-Pakistan announced strict ceasefire along LoC — first in 18 years
- UAE facilitated quiet diplomacy; Saudi Arabia offered economic incentives
- March 2021: Pakistani PM Imran Khan and Indian PM Modi exchanged letters

However, progress stalled after Taliban takeover of Afghanistan (August 2021) and India's shifting strategic priorities.

1.20 Afghanistan Factor: Taliban Takeover (2021-Present)

The Taliban's return to power in August 2021 fundamentally altered South Asian geopolitics, directly impacting India-Pakistan dynamics.

- Pakistan's influence over Taliban government created new strategic leverage
- India lost its \$3 billion+ infrastructure investments and closed consulates
- India-Pakistan rivalry extended to Afghanistan: India supported anti-Taliban factions; Pakistan backed Taliban
- Border tensions increased: Pakistan accused India of using Afghan soil for anti-Pakistan operations

- India-Afghanistan relations soured; Pakistan-Afghanistan ties also deteriorated (TTP sanctuary issues)
- India increasingly engaged with Central Asian republics via Iran's Chabahar port as alternative to Pakistan

1.21 FATF, IMF and Pakistan's Economic Crisis (2021-2024)

- October 2022: FATF removed Pakistan from grey list after 4 years — significant diplomatic victory
- Pakistan faced severe economic crisis: inflation peaked at 38% in 2023; IMF bailout programs
- China provided \$57+ billion in CPEC investments; Saudi Arabia and UAE offered bailouts
- India lobbied to keep Pakistan on FATF grey list; accused of terror financing
- Pakistan's economic vulnerability limited its diplomatic leverage on Kashmir

1.22 G20 in Kashmir & Diplomatic Signaling (2023)

- May 2023: India hosted G20 Tourism Working Group meeting in Srinagar — first major international event in Kashmir since 2019
- China, Saudi Arabia, Turkey boycotted; Egypt, Nigeria, UAE attended
- Pakistan condemned as 'violation of UN resolutions'; China called it 'unilateral change'
- India used G20 to project Kashmir as 'normal' and integrated
- September 2023: India hosted full G20 Summit in Delhi — asserted global leadership role

1.23 Jaishankar's Pakistan Visit & SCO Dynamics (2024)

Key Diplomatic Developments (2024)	
October 2024	Indian EAM S. Jaishankar visited Pakistan for SCO summit — first in 9 years
June 2024	Modi won 3rd consecutive term; Pakistani PM Shehbaz Sharif congratulated
Diplomatic Status	Both countries remained SCO members — potential engagement platform
Trade	Bilateral trade via Dubai remained significant (~\$5 billion annually via third countries)
Visa Restrictions	Limited visa issuance; people-to-people contacts remained minimal

- Jaishankar's visit raised hopes for CBMs but no breakthrough achieved
- Pakistan proposed resuming trade and diplomatic engagement; India insisted on terrorism-first approach

1.24 Pahalgam Attack & May 2025 Military Conflict — LATEST CRITICAL EVENT

The April-May 2025 crisis was the most dangerous India-Pakistan confrontation since 1971, involving missile strikes, drone warfare, and naval combat.

Pahalgam Attack (April 22, 2025)	
Location	Pahalgam, Anantnag district, Indian-administered Kashmir
Victims	26 tourists killed — worst civilian attack in Kashmir in decades
Perpetrator	The Resistance Front (TRF) — India claimed Pakistan-linked proxy
Indian Response	Suspended Indus Waters Treaty; closed Attari-Wagah border; banned trade
Diplomatic Fallout	Expelled diplomats; suspended visas; closed airspace

1.25 Operation Sindoor & Four-Day War (May 6-10, 2025)

May 2025 India-Pakistan Military Conflict	
Duration	May 6-10, 2025 — 4 days of intense fighting
Weapons Used	Precision missiles, fighter jets (Rafale, JF-17), drone swarms, naval assets
Geographic Reach	Strikes extended beyond Kashmir into heartlands — cities hit for first time
Indian Navy	First deployment since 1971; blockade threats
Casualties	Dozens killed on both sides; civilian infrastructure damaged
Nuclear Concerns	Nuclear Command Authority reportedly convened (denied by both)
Ceasefire	May 10, 2025 — brokered by US President Trump; also involved UK, Turkey, Saudi Arabia

- The conflict marked a 'new framework': both sides used AI-assisted drone coordination and precision strikes
- Stability-instability paradox: nuclear deterrence enabled limited conventional war below threshold
- Both countries accelerated arms acquisitions post-ceasefire: drones, air defense, precision missiles

The May 2025 crisis demonstrated that the India-Pakistan relationship has entered a new, more dangerous phase characterized by 'hybrid warfare' — rapidly evolving technology in formal operations and disinformation campaigns.

1.26 Post-May 2025: Arms Race and Fragile Peace (2025-2026)

Post-Conflict Military Buildup (2025-2026)	
India 2025 Spending	\$92.1 billion (+8.9% YoY) — 5th largest globally
Pakistan 2025 Spending	\$11.9 billion (+11% YoY)

Post-Conflict Military Buildup (2025-2026)

India 2026 Hike	+15.2% proposed defense budget
Pakistan 2026 Hike	+13.5% proposed
India's Acquisitions	114 Rafale jets, S-400 systems, Iron Dome-style 'Mission Sudarshan Chakra'
Pakistan's Acquisitions	8 Hangor-class submarines from China, Turkish drones, Chinese missiles

- India strengthened ties with Israel, France, Russia; pushed domestic defense production
- Pakistan deepened defense cooperation with China and Turkey
- Ceasefire violations reported throughout late 2025 and 2026
- India maintained IWT suspension; Pakistan considers it 'act of war' if permanent
- Both sides agreed to military talks (May 12, 2025) but political dialogue remains frozen

Part 2: Kashmir Dispute — Core Conflict Analysis

2.1 Origins and Legal Dimensions

The Kashmir dispute dates to the 1947 Partition when 565+ princely states chose between India and Pakistan. Kashmir was unique: Muslim-majority (~77%) with a Hindu ruler, geographically contiguous to both nations.

- Hari Singh initially sought independence; signed Instrument of Accession to India on October 26, 1947 under military pressure
- Pakistan rejects accession as coerced, illegal, and requiring ratification by Kashmiri people
- India claims accession was final, voluntary, and legally binding under international law
- UN Resolution 47 (1948) established Kashmir as disputed territory requiring plebiscite

"The question of accession... must be decided in accordance with the wishes of the people." — UN Security Council Resolution 47, April 21, 1948

2.2 Territorial Control (2026 Status)

Territorial Division of Kashmir (2026)

India Controls	Jammu, Kashmir Valley, Ladakh (~55% of original princely state; ~12.5 million population)
Pakistan Controls	AJK, Gilgit-Baltistan (~30%; ~5 million population)

Territorial Division of Kashmir (2026)

China Controls	Aksai Chin, Shaksgam Valley (~15%; ceded by Pakistan 1963)
LoC	742 km heavily militarized Line of Control — frequent ceasefire violations
LAC	Line of Actual Control with China — disputed since 1962 war



Figure 3: Kashmir Region showing Line of Control and territorial divisions (Wikimedia)

2.3 India's Position: Arguments and Policy

- Legal: Instrument of Accession (1947) was voluntary and final under international law
- Bilateralism: Simla Agreement (1972) excludes third-party mediation; Kashmir is 'internal matter'
- Terrorism: Pakistan sponsors cross-border terrorism via JeM, LeT, TRF
- Integration: Article 370 was temporary; its removal 'fully integrates' J&K into India

- Development: Post-2019, J&K received \$30+ billion in investments; G20 showcased 'normalcy'
- UT Status: Ladakh as separate UT addresses Buddhist demands; delimitation 'empowers all communities'

2.4 Pakistan's Position: Arguments and Policy

- Legal: Accession was coerced; Kashmir's Muslim majority would have chosen Pakistan
- UN Resolutions: UNSC Resolution 47 mandates plebiscite; India never complied
- Self-Determination: Kashmiris have right to decide under UN Charter Articles 1 and 55
- Human Rights: 700,000+ troops, pellet guns, mass graves, enforced disappearances constitute 'occupation'
- Water Security: India's control of Indus headwaters threatens Pakistan's agricultural survival
- Demographic Engineering: Post-2019 domicile laws allow non-Kashmiris to settle — 'settler colonialism'
- Internationalize: Pakistan lobbies OIC, UNHRC, EU to pressure India on Kashmir

"Kashmir is not a territorial dispute. It is about the right of self-determination of 13 million people." — Former Pakistani PM Imran Khan, UNGA 2019

Part 3: United Nations & Mediation Efforts

3.1 UN Security Council Resolutions

Key UN Resolutions on Kashmir	
Resolution 39 (1948)	Established UNCIP for peaceful resolution
Resolution 47 (1948)	Ceasefire, Pakistani withdrawal, Indian troop reduction, UN plebiscite
Resolution 51 (1948)	Reaffirmed plebiscite call; criticized violations
Resolution 80 (1950)	Simultaneous withdrawal; UN administrator proposal
Resolution 91 (1951)	Indian elections cannot substitute plebiscite
Resolution 122 (1957)	Condemned J&K Constituent Assembly as not substitute for plebiscite
Resolution 126 (1957)	UNMOGIP mandate extended; monitoring continues today

Despite 15+ resolutions, none were implemented due to: (a) Cold War politics, (b) Indian shift to bilateralism post-1972, (c) Pakistan's military instability, (d) lack of enforcement mechanisms.

3.2 UN Military Observer Group (UNMOGIP)

- Established 1949 — one of UN's oldest peacekeeping missions
- Monitors ceasefire along LoC; reports violations to both parties
- India restricts UNMOGIP access to its side since 1972; Pakistan allows full access
- 2024-2026: Recorded highest ceasefire violations during May 2025 conflict

3.3 UN Human Rights Reports

- UN OHCHR Report (June 2018): Documented pellet gun injuries, arbitrary detentions, AFSPA impunity
- UN OHCHR Report (July 2019): Criticized communications blackout, mass arrests post-Article 370
- India rejected both reports as 'fallacious' and 'interference in internal affairs'
- UNHCHR called for international investigation — blocked by India

3.4 Failed Peace Plans

Dixon Plan (1950)

- Proposed partition along religious lines with zonal referendums
- Kashmir Valley would hold plebiscite; Ladakh to India; Northern Areas to Pakistan
- India rejected fearing loss of the Valley; Dixon resigned in frustration

Musharraf Four-Point Formula (2006)

- Demilitarization, self-governance, joint supervision, soft borders
- Closest to peace since 1947; backchannel talks between NSA-level officials
- Mumbai 2008 attacks destroyed all progress

Part 4: Role of Global Powers & Geopolitical Dimensions

4.1 China: Strategic Stakeholder

China's Role in Kashmir (2026)	
Territorial Claim	Aksai Chin (occupied since 1962 Sino-India War)
Shaksgam Valley	Ceded by Pakistan 1963; part of China-Pakistan boundary agreement
CPEC Route	\$57+ billion corridor passes through Gilgit-Baltistan — claimed by India
UNSC Support	Blocks Indian bids to list Pakistani individuals as terrorists
Post-2019 Response	Opposed Ladakh UT; supported Pakistan diplomatically
Military Supply	JF-17 fighters, Hangor submarines, HQ-9 air defense systems
Strategic Interest	Status quo stability for Belt and Road Initiative

- China-Pakistan 'All-Weather Strategic Cooperative Partnership' — India's two-front concern
- Galwan 2020 and Ladakh standoff shifted India's focus; Pakistan benefited from India's China distraction

4.2 United States: Crisis Manager

- Historic mediator during Kargil 1999 and 2001-02 Parliament attack crisis
- Post-9/11: Counterterrorism priority; Pakistan as 'frontline state' in Afghanistan
- Trump offered mediation (2019) — accepted by Pakistan, rejected by India
- May 2025: Trump brokered ceasefire; claimed credit; India downplayed US role
- 2026: Modi-Trump tensions over tariffs; Pakistan mediating US-Iran talks — shifting dynamics
- US strategic tilt toward India via QUAD (US-India-Australia-Japan) concerns Pakistan

4.3 Russia: Arms Supplier to Both

- Historical ally of India; supplies 60%+ of Indian military hardware
- Also supplies Pakistan: Mi-35 helicopters, engine technology for JF-17
- Ukraine war (2022): Russia diverted arms to own use; India sought alternatives (France, Israel)
- Russia maintains neutral stance on Kashmir; abstains at UNSC

4.4 Saudi Arabia & UAE: Economic Influencers

- Financial leverage: oil, loans, remittances, IMF/FATF influence
- UAE awarded Modi Order of Zayed (2019) despite Kashmir row
- Both facilitated backchannel talks (2020-2021); Saudi hosted Pakistani-Indian business forums
- Economic ties with India blunted pro-Pakistan OIC action
- May 2025: UAE and Saudi Arabia involved in ceasefire mediation

4.5 Turkey: Emerging Pakistan Ally

- Erdogan's strong pro-Kashmir rhetoric at UNGA since 2019
- Defense cooperation: Turkish drones (Bayraktar TB2), naval ships, missile tech
- Pakistan-Turkey joint military exercises; intelligence sharing
- Both support Azerbaijan; Turkey-Pakistan-China axis forming

4.6 Organization of Islamic Cooperation (OIC)

- 57-member body; consistently backs Pakistan on Kashmir
- OIC Contact Group on Jammu and Kashmir (est. 1994) — regular statements
- Weakness: Key members (Saudi Arabia, UAE, Egypt) prioritize India trade over Kashmir
- Pakistan uses OIC for moral legitimacy; India dismisses as 'Pakistan's mouthpiece'

Part 5: Economic Dimensions & Trade Dynamics

5.1 Bilateral Trade

India-Pakistan Trade (Pre-2019 and Post-2019)	
Formal Trade (2018)	\$2.4 billion — heavily skewed toward India
Informal Trade (via Dubai)	\$4-5 billion annually
Post-2019	India revoked MFN status; formal trade collapsed
Post-Pulwama 2019	100% customs duty on Pakistani goods; trade near zero
Post-May 2025	Complete trade ban; Attari-Wagah border closed

India-Pakistan Trade (Pre-2019 and Post-2019)

Pakistan's Exports to India	Cement, dry fruits, textiles, surgical instruments
India's Exports to Pakistan	Pharmaceuticals, chemicals, cotton, machinery

5.2 CPEC and Regional Connectivity

- China-Pakistan Economic Corridor: \$57+ billion investment since 2015
- Gwadar Port: Strategic deep-sea port in Balochistan; China operates
- Route passes through Gilgit-Baltistan — India claims as its territory
- India opposes CPEC; develops Chabahar Port in Iran as counter
- CPEC Phase II (2021-2026): Industrial zones, agriculture, IT, special economic zones

5.3 SAARC and Regional Integration Failure

- SAARC is South Asia's regional body — 8 members
- 2016 onwards: India boycotted SAARC summits; Pakistan hosted but India blocked
- BIMSTEC (Bay of Bengal) promoted by India as SAARC alternative
- South Asia remains least integrated region globally (trade < 5% of GDP)
- India-Pakistan rivalry is primary obstacle to regional economic cooperation

Part 6: Nuclear Dimensions & Military Balance (2026)

Nuclear & Military Comparison (2026 Estimates)

India Nuclear Warheads	~180-200 (SIPRI/FAS 2025)
Pakistan Nuclear Warheads	~170-190 (SIPRI/FAS 2025)
India's Doctrine	Cold Start + No First Use (NFU) — increasingly questioned
Pakistan's Doctrine	Full Spectrum Deterrence + First Use threshold
India Military Spending 2025	\$92.1 billion (SIPRI) — 5th globally
Pakistan Military Spending 2025	\$11.9 billion
India Active Personnel	1.45 million — world's 2nd largest standing army
Pakistan Active Personnel	654,000
India Fighter Jets	~600 (Su-30MKI, Rafale, MiG-29, Tejas)

Nuclear & Military Comparison (2026 Estimates)	
Pakistan Fighter Jets	~450 (JF-17, F-16, Mirage III/IV)
India Navy	Aircraft carriers (2), nuclear submarines, destroyers
Pakistan Navy	Frigates, 8 new Hangor-class submarines from China

6.1 Post-May 2025 Arms Race

- Both countries racing for drone warfare capabilities — swarms, counter-drones
- India developing 'Mission Sudarshan Chakra' (Iron Dome equivalent) with Israel
- Pakistan acquiring Chinese HQ-9 and Turkish air defense systems
- Hypersonic missiles and anti-satellite weapons under development
- AI integration in surveillance, drone coordination, and command systems

Analysts warn of 'stability-instability paradox': nuclear deterrence enabling limited conventional wars that could escalate unpredictably.



Figure 4: India-Pakistan Nuclear Overview. Data: SIPRI / Center for Arms Control

Part 7: Human Rights & Humanitarian Concerns

Documented Human Rights Issues in Kashmir (1989-2026)	
Total Deaths	70,000-90,000+ (government vs civil society estimates)
Security Forces	700,000-800,000 deployed in Kashmir Valley
Pellet Gun Victims (2016)	6,221 injured; 1,178 with eye damage
Mass Graves	2,700+ unmarked graves (Kupwara, Baramulla, 2009)
Disappeared Persons	8,000+ (APDP documentation)
Kashmiri Pandit Exodus	350,000-400,000 displaced in 1990s
Internet Shutdowns	213 days (2019-2020); world's longest
Journalists Arrested	Multiple under UAPA; Fahad Shah, Sajad Gul detained
Widows	32,000+ conflict widows in Kashmir (estimated)
Orphans	108,000+ children orphaned (social org estimates)

7.1 Post-2019 Human Rights Concerns

- Mass arrests of politicians, activists, lawyers under PSA and UAPA
- Complete communications blackout: internet, mobile phones, landlines severed
- Foreign journalists, UN observers, diplomats denied access to Kashmir
- Domicile law changes allowing non-Kashmiris to acquire residency
- Electoral gerrymandering via delimitation favoring Jammu region
- Ongoing militant attacks: Pahalgam 2025 (26 tourists), periodic encounters

7.2 International Response

- UN OHCHR Reports (2018, 2019): Called for international investigation — India rejected
- EU Parliament Debates (2020, 2021): Expressed concern over rights situation
- OIC Contact Group: Regular resolutions condemning Indian actions
- US State Department Reports: Annual criticism of AFSPA, PSA, extrajudicial killings
- Amnesty International (2020): Stripped of FCRA license; office closed in India

Part 8: Water Security & Climate Change — Emerging Threat

8.1 Indus Waters Treaty Crisis

The IWT was the most enduring institution between India and Pakistan — surviving 4 wars. Its suspension in 2025 marks a dangerous new phase.

- September 2016: Modi first threatened to revoke IWT post-Uri attack
- India accelerated Kishanganga (330 MW) and Ratle (850 MW) dam projects
- Pakistan approached World Bank Court of Arbitration
- April 2025: India formally suspended IWT following Pahalgam attack
- Pakistan considers IWT abrogation as existential threat and potential casus belli

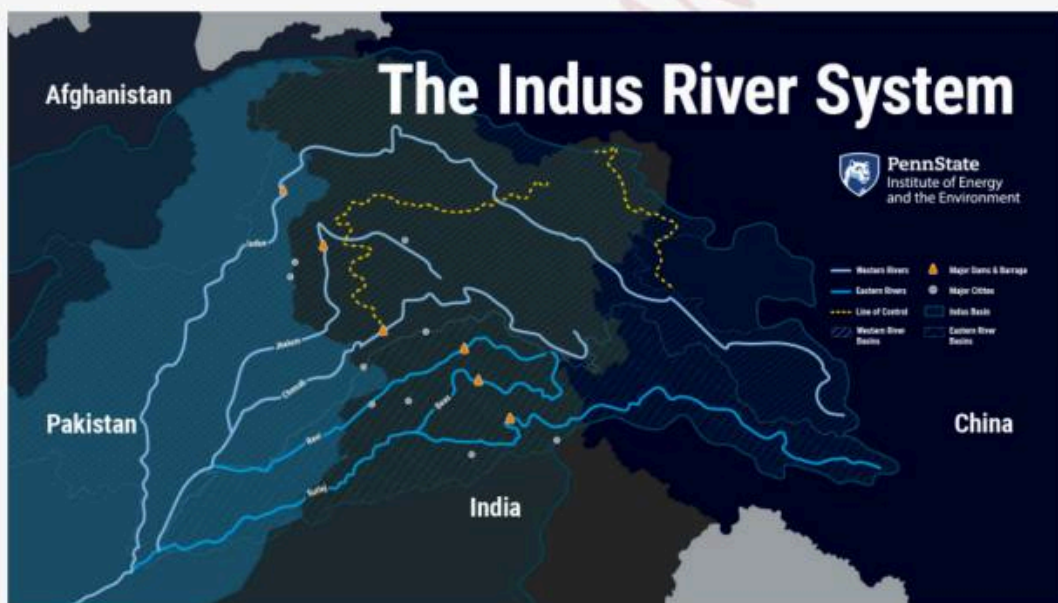


Figure 5: The Indus River System. Source: Penn State Institute of Energy and Environment

8.2 Climate Change & Water Scarcity

- South Asia is most climate-vulnerable region globally
- Himalayan glaciers melting rapidly; Indus flow declining
- Pakistan ranked 8th most climate-vulnerable country (Global Climate Risk Index)
- Water scarcity could trigger future conflict even without political tensions

- India's control of headwaters gives strategic leverage Pakistan cannot match

Part 9: Way Forward – Proposed Solutions & Strategic Options

9.1 Reviving Existing Frameworks

- UN Resolution 47 Implementation: Updated plebiscite with modern international supervision
- Dixon Plan Revival: Regional referendums respecting current demographics
- Musharraf Formula Redux: Demilitarization, self-governance, joint management, soft borders
- Simla Agreement Plus: Bilateral dialogue expanded to include Kashmiri representatives

9.2 Innovative Solutions

- Kashmir as Joint Condominium: India-Pakistan joint sovereignty with maximum autonomy
- EU-Ireland Model: Hard border becomes soft border; free movement, joint economic zone
- Independent Kashmir: Neutral, demilitarized state guaranteed by major powers
- Autonomy Referendum: District-by-district votes on autonomy levels under international observers

9.3 Confidence-Building Measures

- Restore Cross-LoC Trade: Rice, carpets, saffron, surgical goods, pharmaceuticals
- Expand Kartarpur: Model for religious tourism corridors (Sharda Peeth, Sufi shrines)
- People-to-People Contact: Visa relaxations for families, students, journalists, artists
- Media Exchanges: Joint TV programs, film collaborations, sports (cricket diplomacy)
- Track-II Diplomacy: Revive Aman Ki Asha, academic conferences, think tank dialogues

9.4 Role of International Community

- UN: Appoint Special Rapporteur for Kashmir; mandate UNHCHR investigation
- US: Leverage influence with both; offer mediation if both agree

- China: As CPEC stakeholder and territorial claimant, has unique leverage
- EU: Economic incentives conditional on human rights improvements
- SCO: Use membership platform for structured bilateral engagement

9.5 Internal Reforms in Indian-Administered Kashmir

- Demilitarization: Gradual troop reduction starting with civilian areas
- Repeal AFSPA: End immunity for security forces; prosecute violations
- Release Political Prisoners: Free detainees under PSA; allow political activity
- Restore Internet: Ensure uninterrupted communications
- Economic Development: Genuine investment creating Kashmiri jobs and ownership

Part 10: Verified Statistics & References

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- Christian Science Monitor (May 2026) — 'Amid India-Pakistan arms race' — SIPRI data verification.
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